

Figure 2-6. *Uploading*

Pressing the Upload button will send a signal to the Arduino microcontroller that tells it that it needs to stop what it's doing and pay attention to the incoming code. At this point the LEDs marked RX/TX on the interface board will blink like mad, indicating that the code is being transferred to the board using serial communications through the transmitting (TX) and receiving (RX) of data using the built-in USB to Serial converter. When all is said and done, the notice bar will tell you when the upload is complete and your sketch will begin running momentarily.

Common Errors

You've just punched in your new sketch with eager anticipation to see that LED blink. You hit the Verify button, and after a long second or two, an error pops up. Now what?

If things didn't go as planned because of a compiler error, the notice bar will turn orange and sometimes give you a cryptic form of message, as seen in Figure 2-7, that basically tells you to go back and fix something.